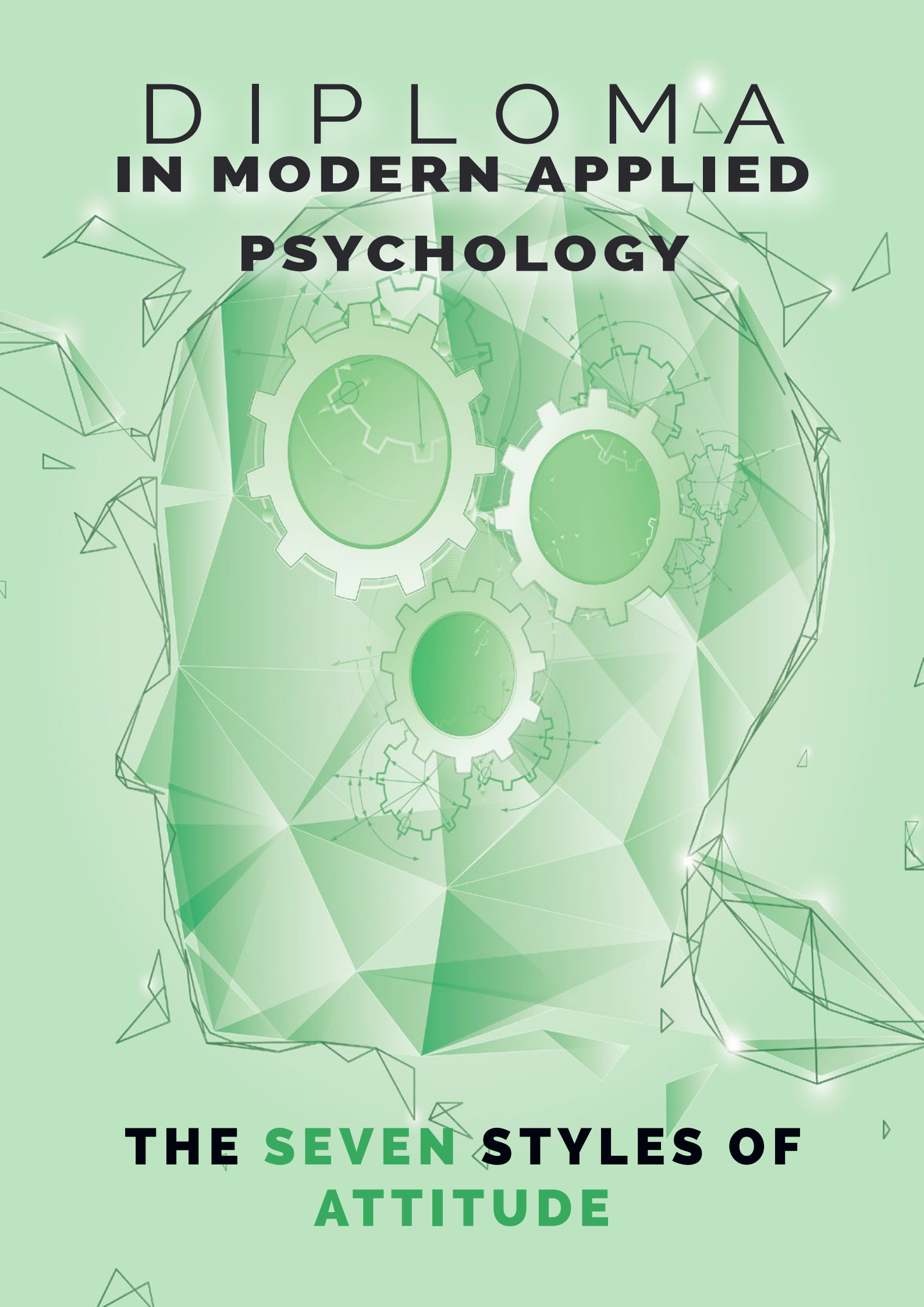


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a vibrant green with a complex, low-poly geometric pattern. Overlaid on this are several interlocking gears of different sizes, some in white and some in green. Thin, light-green lines with arrows at their ends crisscross the entire image, creating a sense of movement and interconnectedness. The overall aesthetic is modern and technological.

THE SEVEN STYLES OF ATTITUDE

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Hierarchy of Bias

We all have biases against certain types of people (whether we'd like to admit it or not). It's incredibly hard, if not impossible, to be free from bias: we all have things we like and respect, and we all have attitudes, beliefs, actions and people who we don't respect or agree with. Whilst it's easy to think of yourself as unbiased because you're accepting of all people from different ethnicities, religions, sexualities and genders, that doesn't mean you're not biased against criminals, murderers, people in certain professions or people who eat certain diets.

Biased Attitudes:

The lowest and least dangerous form of bias is that which is attitudinal. Attitudinal bias includes stereotyping, making insensitive remarks, being afraid of those who are different, using non-inclusive language, engaging in microaggressions, keeping yourself within an echo chamber of those who agree with you and accepting negative or misinformative information concerning that which you are biased against.

Acts of Bias:

The step above general biased attitudes is acting upon one's bias. This involves bullying, ridiculing, and insulting those whom you are biased against. It also includes engaging in derogatory humour and using slurs or language which dehumanises others. These acts of bias are targeted against sects of people who others have generalised based on the experience they've had of one (or a couple) of people from that group.

Discrimination:

Discrimination is usually a more socio-political statement and it is a systematic problem. Societies and cultures, in general, have been built up due to the discrimination of others, and therefore discrimination is a wide-scale issue. Those of particular races, sexes, classes, sexualities and genders find themselves economically, politically and educationally discriminated against. Certain people find it near impossible to have the same housing and employment opportunities as those who are systematically privileged, and the criminal justice system is more forgiving and less judgemental and biased against those who aren't marginalised.

Bias Motivated Violence:

Due to systematic narratives, bias-motivated violence is becoming more normalised and frequent. People are murdered, raped, assaulted and threatened because of who they are, who they love or what they believe (or don't believe) in. Terrorism, vandalism and arson have been embraced by small but powerful sects of people who wish the world was the way they want it to be, and they use fear and death to try and eliminate and control others who they don't accept.

Genocide:

The highest and most extreme form of bias is genocide which is the deliberate and systematic attempt to annihilate entire groups of people. Those who commit genocide, or anyone who engages in any forms of violence or discrimination, believe their intentions are as pure and good as you do yours.



THE SEVEN STYLES OF ATTITUDE

Seven Styles of Attitude

On a general, daily basis, we reject those with different attitudes to ours.

Commonality vs Difference

People usually always seek out aspects of commonality to help them relate and connect with others. However, there are those who thrive off finding the difference and enjoy being argumentative or difficult. There are pros and cons to both approaches in life is taken to the extreme, however, the most successful and open people in life are those who make sense and meaning out of their lives through finding and appreciating both commonality and difference in the world.

Away from pain vs Towards pleasure

There are many proactive people in life who pursue the things that they want from life, but there are many whose focus is more on what they do not want from life and so act in ways to avoid it at all cost. However, the cruel irony is that what we focus most on in life is what we end up gravitating towards. Focussing on a more values-based goal is more fulfilling and productive focusing on what they don't like about themselves and their life.

Independent vs Co-creator

Independent people tackle the world head-on, largely alone. They're focused on having their own way and maintaining their own preferences in life. Co-creators, on the other hand, focus on meeting in the middle; they want to ensure that everyone is happy. They do this by working together with people to reach compromises so that no one is left dissatisfied or unhappy with their circumstances.

Self-Referenced vs Other Referenced

Self-referenced people always refer incidents back to their own perceptions and experiences; they relate everyone's pains, happiness, successes and failures to their own. Self-referencing people undermine other people's experiences and fail to deliver true empathy and compassion to others. Other referenced people live to serve others; they want to help others and accept everyone. However, other referenced people must maintain a balance, otherwise, they can risk becoming martyrs. A balance needs to be struck between the two reference points; we must be self-reflective without being self-absorbed, and we must be other-referenced without becoming neglectful and reckless.

Obtaining vs Sustaining

This is the difference between short and long term thinkers; those who wish to be instantly gratified vs those who seek sustainable fulfilment. When we're false, loud and flashy, it's easy to obtain likes on Facebook, brief notoriety, friends online, and followers on Twitter, but sustaining takes a lot more thought and effort. Sustainable lifestyles focus on quality over quantity; they're minimal lifestyles with little to no external noise around them.

Necessity Must vs Possibility options

Rule keepers in society tend to have a boxed-in world view; they believe life must be like x or people should do y in life, as though there is a manual for life and successful living. Those, however, who see the world as a realm of endless opportunities sees the multitude of options everyone has before them. They don't believe life should be played out according to some standard or expectation, rather, that people should live life freely with an open mind to change.



THE SEVEN STYLES OF ATTITUDE

Internal vs External frame of reference

Our frame of reference refers to how we make sense of things in life. Some people have an external frame of reference, which means that they externalise new information either through speaking or writing. Those with an internal frame of reference, however, internalise all their thought processes; they choose to remain silent when processing information and keep their thoughts entirely to themselves.

Exercise:

1. Which of these attitude styles do you operate most out of? Give examples:

2. Think of times you've either rubbed other people up the wrong way (or others have rubbed you up the wrong way) because of your differing attitude styles. Can you identify which styles you find difficult to be around and which attitude styles you operate out of which others may find difficult? Give examples.